

Baruch Haba

429a

Version 2

Julius Mombach
Arr. Stuart Izon

Psalm 118 begins and ends with one of the most well known verses in the liturgy: "Praise the Lord for He is good, His kindness is eternal." The Psalm is read in its entirety during the Hallel service. Although not a halachic requirement, many wedding ceremonies traditionally begin with the last four verses of Psalm 118. "Baruch Haba", literally "Blessed be he who enters", is customarily sung to welcome the groom to the chuppah. (The phrase "Brucha Haba'a" was historically used to welcome the bride to the chuppah, though some traditions instead use the text of "Baruch Haba" itself for the bride's entrance.)

Here is Mombach's spectacular Baruch Haba. Whilst he wrote several other melodies for this text, this composition was specifically intended for weddings, and was notably sung at the wedding of Baron Ferdinand and Evelina De Rothschild. Its pomp and ceremony befits the tone and pageantry of the formal wedding service. In recent years it has fallen out of favour probably due to a combination of preference for a less formal wedding service, choirs being less popular in general, the advent of electronic instruments and a dearth of skilled choristers. Nevertheless it is still occasionally performed, and when done well heralds a glorious start to the chuppah ceremony.

Maestoso

Melody Alto

Tenor Bass

8 *f* Ba - ruch ha - ba b' - shem a - do - nai be -

6 M A *f* -rach - nu - chem mi - beit a - do - nai El a - do -

T B

11 M A *mp* -nai va - ya - er la - nu is - ru chag ba -

T B

15

M
A

8

- a - vo - tim ad kar - not ha-miz - be - ach E - li a -

mp

T
B

19

M
A

8

- ta v' - o - de - ka e - lo hai a -

mp

T
B

24

M
A

8

- ro - m' - me - ka Ho - du la - do - nai ki tov ki

p

T
B

28

M
A

8

l' - o - lam chas - do ki l' - o - lam

T
B

32

M
A

8

f *ff* *ff*

chas - do l' - o - lam chas - do l' - o - lam chas - do l' - o - lam chas -

T
B

36

M
A

8

allarg.

-do l' - o - lam chas - do l' - o - lam chas - do

T
B